



Young & Black

By Daniel Akinjise

Mental Health intervention for young and black professionals in Canada

Problem

HOW RACIAL DISCRIMINATION IN THE WORKPLACE CONTRIBUTES TO THE MENTAL HEALTH CHALLENGES AFFECTING YOUNG AND BLACK PROFESSIONALS IN CANADA

In Canada, **mental illness** stands as a prominent disability affecting human's daily activities and productivity, with about **500,000 Canadians** missing work due to it every week. The repercussions that arise from mental illness can be felt by individuals, organizations and the economy.

Research has it that young Black people schooling in Canada stated that racial stereotypes have the potential to negatively impact their development and opportunities, while in the workplace **54%** black professionals viewed discrimination at the workplace as a major cause of mental health challenges like anxiety, depression, stress and addiction/substance use disorder.

According to a research conducted at Boston University, USA: **20 out of 24** racialized people said they used alcohol and other substances to deal with depression and negative emotions, which then results into addiction.

SOME STATISTICS

- 1 in 5 Canadians experience mental illness every year- [CAMH Survey](#)
- According to a [study](#) conducted by researchers at the University of Ottawa, nearly two-thirds (65.87 per cent) of Black individuals in Canada suffer from depression, with women being impacted more.
- According to a [survey](#) by the Mental Health Commission, 38.3% of Black Canadians with mental health issues used mental health services between 2001-2014 compared to 50.8% of White Canadians.
- 75% of black respondents of [HR Reporter survey](#) said they would be reluctant to disclose a mental illness to an employer or co-worker for fear losing their jobs and public stigma.
- In fact, a 2018 [survey](#) found that 60% of Black Canadians would be more willing to use mental health services if the mental health professional was Black.



SUMMARY OF EXTERNAL FEEDBACK

“there’s need to support black professionals who have mental health needs”.

“Racial discrimination and stigmatization is affecting the mental health of black people, and nobody is talking about it”.

“ We aren’t getting employment opportunities because we are young and black”



Hypothesis

The negative impact of racial discrimination in the workplace is directly correlated with the higher prevalence of mental health issues among young and Black professionals in Canada.

Target Audience

Young and black professionals
between the ages of 18-35 years





Historically, Black people have been negatively impacted by discrimination in the healthcare system. Even to this day, individuals sometimes deal with provider bias, both conscious and unconscious, which can result in misdiagnosis and inadequate treatment. This leads to mistrust in reaching out to mental health professionals.

As a result, we are creating a platform that advocates for young and black professionals affected by mental health challenges (Stress, depression, anxiety, gender-based violence and addiction). We understand that people between the ages of **18 to 35** are mostly found on social media, and we intend to use this medium to connect them to relevant mental health services and resources- **therapists, courses, articles and podcasts** using our culturally tailored approach.

YOUNG & BLACK OFFERS:

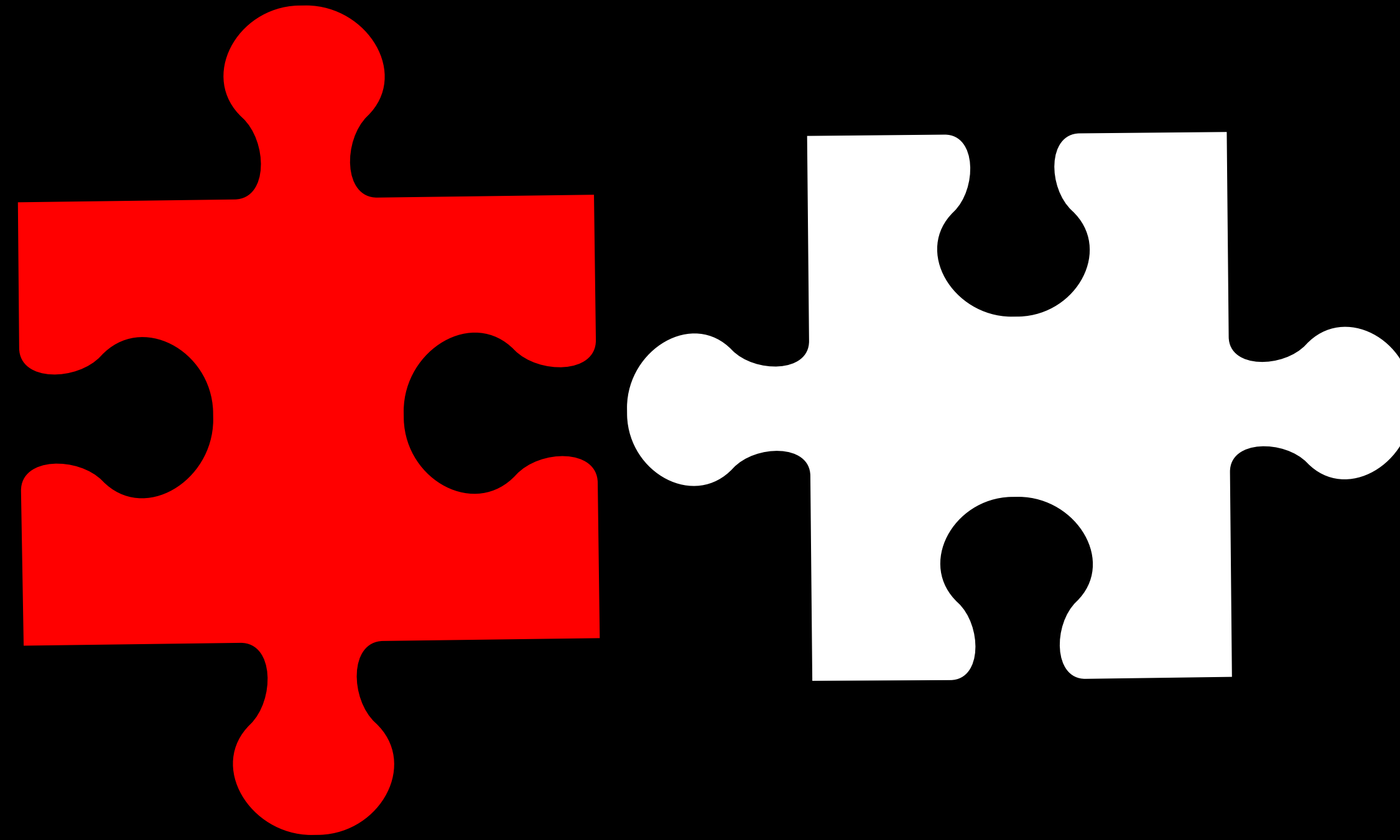
- Culturally tailored approach that connects professionals to counselors with same racial background.
- Identifying barriers and providing access to customized resources (Career & entrepreneurship Support)
- Access to peer support and mentorship groups.
- Development of online advocacy programs on black mental health & sales of merchandizes for awareness.

JUST TO SAY

We are focusing on how racial discrimination contributes to mental health issues amongst young and black professionals in the Canadian workforce and labor market.

HOW WE HELP

Creating safe spaces for young professionals who are affected by mental health issues and connecting them to culturally tailored mental health resources.



HOW THE SOLUTION WILL BE ACHIEVED

Goal: To support 50 young & black professionals in Canada within the next one year

- Development of website for brand identity and advocacy/ corporate communications.
- Development of database on the website to share resources and collect participant's data.
- Creation of social media platforms for campaign and awareness, with the aim of sensitizing the general public on the importance of anti-racism, diversity and inclusion in the workplace.
- Collected data of young and black professionals with mental health needs will be used in connecting them to mental health counselors, and other relevant/customized resources of assistance.
- Purchase and design of merchandise (Shirts and caps) for sale to create more awareness.
- Provision of career development support to young and black professionals (resume writing and interview prepping), which can be extended to black newcomers and refugees.

Requested Funding Amount

\$10,000

How funding will be used

S/N	Item	Amount (\$)	Total (\$)
1	Website Hosting, Design and Development	\$350	\$350
2	Database Management	\$150 per annum	\$150
3	Paid Social Media Campaigns/Advocacy	\$100 per month x 12	\$1,200
4	Cost of engaging Mental Health Counselors	\$100 per session x 50	\$5,000
5	Creation of merchandise for sale (Tee Shirts)	\$20 per unit x 50	\$1,000
6	Career Development Support (Coaching, Resume writing or Interview prepping)	\$50 per session x 50	\$2,500
7	Purchase of Laptop Computer & Accessories for Administrative duties	\$1000	\$1,000
8	Logistics and Miscellaneous	\$800	\$800
	Total		\$12,000

REACH OUT

www.youngandblackcanada.ca



@youngandblackcanada



RESOURCES

Black with Mental health Challenges

- The Centre for Addiction and Mental Health (CAMH)
 - Anti-Black Racism Mental Health Resources
 - Dialogue on Mental Health
 - Research conducted at Boston University.

CREATED BY

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OTHER INFORMATION

Young & Black Loom Video

Sub-focus Area: Diversity & Cultural Sensitivity in Mental Health Resources.

Solution type: Service Idea

In-kind business Partner opportunities: Mentorship